James Higgins

TECHNICAL PROJECT MANAGER & FULL-STACK DEVELOPER

Vancouver, BC

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Open to both full-time and contract-based opportunities

Technical project management, grounded in 12+ years of hands-on development.

I lead web projects from scoping and estimation through launch and long-term support, coordinating designers, developers, content creators and QA. Because I have built WordPress, PHP and e-commerce platforms myself, my estimates reflect how the work actually gets done, my architecture and DevOps guidance is practical, and developers get clear answers without a hand-off.

I hold every project to the same standard: disciplined version control, repeatable deployments, documented decisions and clean handovers.

Selected work

MICROSOFT

Bing Blogs (https://blogs.bing.com/)

Managed the upgrade from Kentico 11 to 13, including an MVC rebuild of the templates and a move to Azure App Service.

Technical Project Manager · Falcon Software

PROVINCE OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

BritishColumbia.ca (https://www.britishcolumbia.ca/)

Led the development phase of the province's redesign and migration to WordPress, including multilingual support with WPML.

Technical Project Manager · Falcon Software

HEALTHSTREAM

HealthStream.com (https://www.healthstream.com/)

Managed the redevelopment of the corporate site for a US healthcare workforce company, introducing a card-based system of reusable components alongside custom widgets and features.

Technical Project Manager · Falcon Software

Experience

Technical Project Manager

Falcon Software Company Inc. September 2020 – present

- Manage web projects for public-sector, healthcare and member-organization clients, now delivered through Falcon's KPMG partnership, owning scope, estimates, schedule and stakeholder reporting.
- Led Falcon's Microsoft Bing Blogs engagement, managing the Kentico 11 to 13 upgrade, the MVC rebuild of its templates and the move to Azure App Service.
- Led IBM partner projects for the Government of British Columbia, including the development phase of the BritishColumbia.ca redesign and WordPress migration with multilingual support through WPML.
- Managed the redevelopment of HealthStream.com, introducing a card-based system of reusable components alongside custom widgets and features.
- For the Health Sciences Association of Saskatchewan, launched a WooCommerce merchandise store, redeveloped the collective agreement browser, and currently lead the rebuild of the member information portal.
- Implemented CI/CD with Bitbucket Pipelines, including Webpack front-end builds and Bitbucket deployments integrated with Jira so stakeholders can trace each release to its tickets.
- Provide fine-grained time and cost estimates, advise on code architecture and DevOps strategy, and direct UX and UI decisions with client stakeholders.

Tools: WordPress, WooCommerce, WPML, Kentico, Sitefinity, Jira, Bitbucket Pipelines, Webpack, Microsoft Azure, Azure App Service, ASP.NET MVC, WP Engine, UnderStrap, Microsoft Teams

Technical Project Manager

NativeAds July 2019 – May 2020

- Managed web advertising projects end to end, including website builds, PPC funnels, landing pages and lead-generation systems, with detailed time and cost estimates for each.
- Managed the technical implementation of a private CPA network on the HasOffers/Tune platform, including conversion tracking through postbacks and pixels.
- Led a company-wide initiative to build a knowledge base and introduce Git version control.

Tools: WordPress, PHP, Google Analytics, Monday.com, Git, Slack

Contract Web Developer

Ryders Eyewear November 2016 – November 2019

- Maintained and extended the brand's direct-to-consumer WordPress/WooCommerce store.
- Reverse-engineered and rebuilt the store's automated build and deployment pipeline, with containerized local development in Lando and dev, test and live environments on Pantheon.
- Delivered features covering third-party marketing and tracking integrations, checkout changes and catalogue restructuring.
- Produced MySQL reports for business analysis.

Tools: WordPress, WooCommerce, PHP, Pantheon, Lando, Docker, Git, MySQL, Gulp

Web Developer

The Rand Group June 2017 – October 2018

- Managed and developed the company's own sites, RandGroup.com and Dynamics101.com, and client sites including HoustonSymphony.org, itsolutions.bdo.ca and LSRetail.com for a Microsoft Dynamics solutions partner.
- Built responsive front ends in Bootstrap 3 and 4, added multilingual support with WPML, and integrated marketing automation through ClickDimensions and Microsoft CRM.
- Provided monthly maintenance, updates and cross-browser compatibility reporting.

Tools: WordPress, Microsoft CRM, Microsoft Azure, WPML, jQuery, Bootstrap 4, Asana

Web Developer

Noble Pixels 2017 – 2018

- Developed CMS interfaces for user stories across three production applications in an in-house Agile environment.
- Created and modified REST API endpoints consumed by reusable Vue.js components.
- Built admin reporting tables and interfaces using Eloquent ORM and raw SQL.

Tools: Laravel, Vue.js, MySQL, jQuery, Git

Developer

Soulpepper March 2016 – March 2018

- Managed and developed the agency's Magento store, RoderickAllan.com, and set up its Git deployment workflow on Beanstalk.
- Integrated third-party stock data from Google Sheets into Magento with Magmi through a custom PHP cron job.
- Wrote project proposals for prospective clients and worked alongside SEO, PPC and marketing specialists on campaign tracking.

Tools: Magento, PHP, MySQL, Beanstalk, Git

Web Developer & Consultant

James Higgins Web Development 2013 – present

- Design, build and maintain WordPress sites for agencies and direct clients, from scoping and estimates through launch and ongoing support.
- Build and support e-commerce stores on WooCommerce, Shopify and Magento, including custom checkout, catalogue and third-party integrations.
- Develop and maintain DevOps implementations for client projects: Git-based workflows, containerized local environments, staged dev, test and live deployments, and automated builds.
- Hold every build to professional standards, with clean version history, documented handovers, and attention to performance and security.

Tools: WordPress, WooCommerce, PHP, Shopify, Magento, MySQL, Git, Docker, Lando

Skills

DELIVERY

Scoping & estimation, Backlog & release management, Stakeholder reporting, Agile & Kanban, Partner & vendor coordination, DevOps strategy, UX & UI direction, Team leadership

ENGINEERING

WordPress & WooCommerce, PHP & Laravel, JavaScript, Vue.js & React, REST APIs, SQL, HTML, CSS & Sass, Webpack & front-end build tooling, CI/CD with Bitbucket Pipelines, Magento & Shopify, LAMP / LEMP

Tools: Jira, Basecamp, Asana, Monday.com, Trello, Microsoft Teams, Git, Bitbucket, Bitbucket Pipelines, Webpack, Docker, Lando, Linux, WP Engine, Pantheon, Microsoft Azure, Kentico, Sitefinity.

Education

Applied Web Development

British Columbia Institute of Technology

BA, Philosophy

University of British Columbia